

ACC250: Intro to Financial Accounting

Ch1. Business Decisions and Financial Accounting

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Learning Objectives

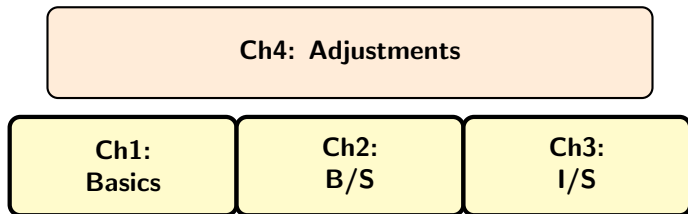
- Compare sole proprietorships, partnerships, and corporations.
- Apply the basic accounting equation: $\text{Assets} = \text{Liabilities} + \text{Shareholders' Equity}$.
- Read the four financial statements and how each one feeds the next.
- Classify activities as operating, investing, or financing.

Structure of Chapters

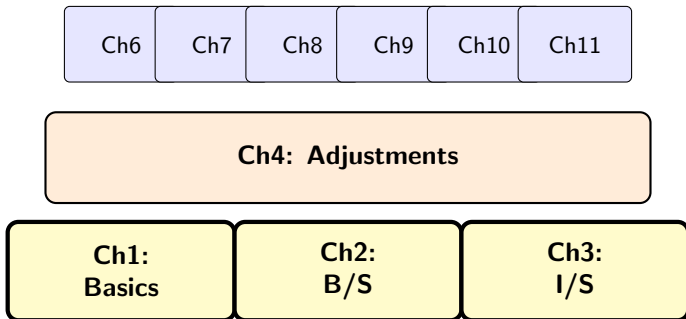
**Ch1:
Basics**

**Ch2:
B/S**

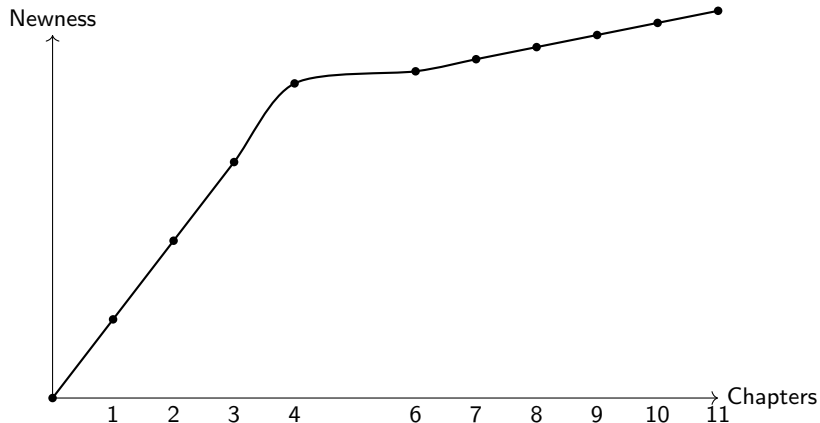
**Ch3:
I/S**



Structure of Chapters



Structure of Chapters



You have reasons to stay focused in the first part of the course!
Once you understand Ch1-Ch4, you will have a solid foundation for the rest of the course!

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- 1 Corporations as a Common Form of Business Organization
- 2 Accounting for Business Decisions
- 3 Basic Accounting Equation: $A = L + SHE$
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 - Liabilities
 - Shareholders' Equity
 - $A = L + SHE$
- 4 Financial Statements
 - Income Statement
 - Statement of Retained Earnings
 - Balance Sheet
 - Statement of Cash Flows
 - Relationship between Financial Statements
- 5 Types of Business Activities
- 6 Closing Illustration
- 7 List of A & L accounts

Opening Illustration

- Year 1:
 - ▶ Imagine you open a lemonade stand all by yourself.
 - ▶ You're the only owner—this is called a sole proprietorship.



Year 1

Sole proprietorship

Opening Illustration

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 - ▶ Imagine you open a lemonade stand all by yourself.
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- Year 2:
 - ▶ After a while, you ask your sister to help you run the stand.
 - ▶ Now, there are two owners working together—this is a partnership.



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Sole proprietorship



Year 2

Partnership

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- Year 2:
 - ▶ After a while, you ask your sister to help you run the stand.
 - ▶ Now, there are two owners working together—this is a partnership.
- Year 3:
 - ▶ Some local friends want to invest and become part-owners.
 - ▶ Now, you all become shareholders in a corporation.



Year 1
Sole proprietorship



Year 2
Partnership



Year 3
Corporation

❶ Sole proprietorship:

- ▶ A business owned and operated by one individual.
- ▶ **No distinction** between your personal assets and liabilities and your firm's.
- ▶ If your firm owes a supplier \$1 million and cannot pay, you owe the debt personally.
- ▶ Your liability is **unlimited**.

1 Sole proprietorship:

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- ▶ Your liability is **unlimited**.

2 Partnership:

- ▶ The same is true, except there are multiple owners.

3 Corporation:

- ▶ A **separate legal entity**: the corporation's assets and liabilities are separate from your personal assets and liabilities.
- ▶ If your corporation owes a supplier \$1 million, it is not your debt.
- ▶ Even if the company goes bankrupt, you are not obligated to pay the firm's debt.
- ▶ This protection is called **limited liability**.

Form	N (owners)	Limited Liab?	Separate Entity?
Sole Prop.	1		
Partnership	2+		
<u>Corporation</u>	1+ [*]		

^{*}Usually 1K+

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Partnership	2+	No	No
<u>Corporation</u>	1+ [*]	<u>Yes</u>	<u>Yes</u>

* Usually 1K+

- A corporation is distinguished from its owners (shareholders).
- Shares can be bought and sold, allowing for easy transfer of ownership.
- A corporation can enter into contracts, sue and be sued, and own property in its own name.
- A corporation's liabilities are not the liabilities of its owners.

Corporations - Limited Liability

- Owners' liabilities are **limited to their investment** in the corporation.
- This limited liability protects shareholders' personal assets from being used to satisfy the corporation's debts.

In this course, we focus on **corporations**.



SpartanNash.

W.K. Kellogg Co.



 **BorgWarner**



Corporations can be classified into two types:

- Private companies: companies with shares not publicly traded
- Public companies: companies with shares listed on a stock exchange (e.g., NYSE, NASDAQ)

A couple more facts:

- There are more than 4K public companies in the US.
- SpaceX just went public (i.e., it is now a public company).

1 Corporations as a Common Form of Business Organization

2 Accounting for Business Decisions

3 Basic Accounting Equation: $A = L + SHE$

- Assets
- Liabilities
- Shareholders' Equity
- $A = L + SHE$

4 Financial Statements

- Income Statement
- Statement of Retained Earnings
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- Relationship between Financial Statements

5 Types of Business Activities

6 Closing Illustration

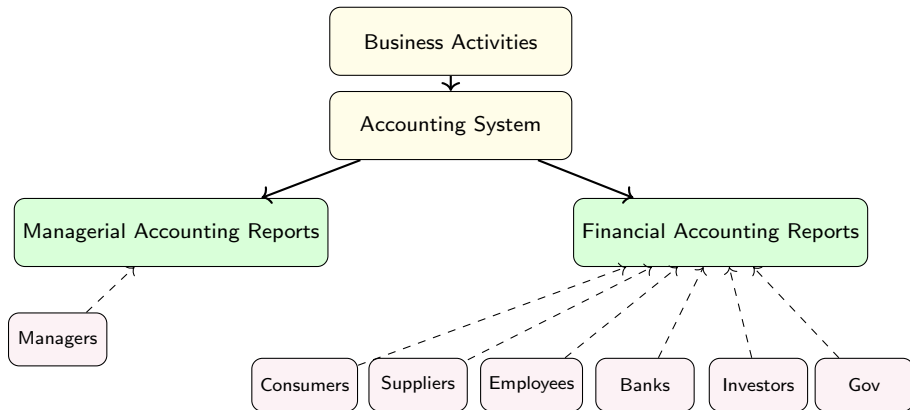
7 List of A & L accounts

- Accounting is the language of business.

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- Accounting provides information for decision-making.

Accounting for Business Decisions

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- **Managers:** Use accounting information to help run the business.
- **Consumers:** Decide whether to buy the business's products or services.
- **Suppliers:** Check if the business can pay for goods and services.
- **Employees:** Look at the business's finances for job security and pay.
- **Banks:** Decide whether to lend money to the business.
- **Investors:** Decide whether to buy or sell shares in the business.
- **Governments:** Use information to set taxes and check rules are followed.

Usefulness of Accounting

Accounting is used to help stakeholders^a make decisions.

^a[Stakeholders](#) are the parties whose decisions depend on the company, or who are affected by it — the seven groups listed above. They are not the same as [shareholders](#), who are the owners and only one of these groups.

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Basic Accounting Equation: $A = L + SHE$

Basic Accounting Equation

- Assets (A) = Liabilities (L) + Stockholders' Equity (SHE)
(Resources) = (Sources of Resources)

What are A, L, and SHE?

Assets (A)

Resources owned by a company that are expected to provide future economic benefits.

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Resources owned by a company that are expected to provide future economic benefits.

Examples:

- Cash: \$10K
- Equipment: \$20K (e.g., airplanes for United Airlines; factories for Dow Chemical)
- Inventory: \$10K (e.g., shoes held for sale by Crocs)



EX 1. What assets do you have after the following transactions?

- You opened a lemonade stand after investing \$50K in cash.
- You bought \$20K of equipment - paid in cash.
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Cash: _____

Equipment: _____

Total Assets: _____

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Cash: \$60K (50K - 20K - 0 + 30K)

Equipment: _____

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Equipment: \$20K

Total Assets: \$80K

EX 2. What assets do you have after the following transactions?

- You opened a lemonade stand after investing \$50K in cash.
- You bought \$20K of equipment - **on credit**¹.
- Your employees worked for your business and you owe them \$10K.
- Your revenues are \$30K and all collected in cash.

Cash: _____

Equipment: _____

Total Assets: _____

¹**On credit** means you received the goods now but will pay later. No cash moves today; instead you take on an obligation to pay, which is a **liability**.

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Cash: \$80K (50K - 0 - 0 + 30K)

Equipment: _____

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Cash: \$80K (50K - 0 - 0 + 30K)

Equipment: \$20K

Total Assets: \$100K

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Liabilities (L)

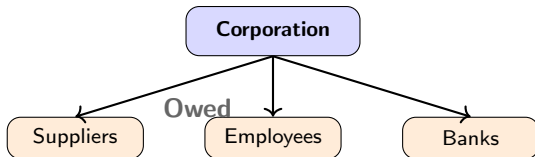
Obligations of a company arising from past transactions, the settlement of which is expected to result in an outflow of resources.

Liabilities (L)

Obligations of a company arising from past transactions, the settlement of which is expected to result in an outflow of resources.

Examples:

- Accounts Payable: \$10K (owed to suppliers)
- Salaries Payable: \$10K (owed to employees)
- Notes Payable: \$20K (owed to banks)



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Salaries Payable: _____

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Total Liabilities: \$30K

Stockholders' Equity (SHE)

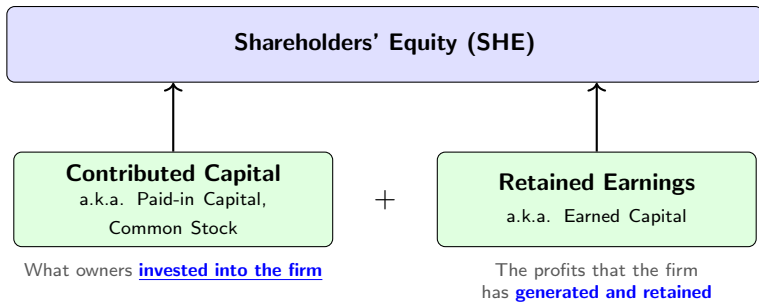
The residual interest in the assets of a company after deducting liabilities; represents the owners' claims on the business.

Shareholders' Equity

Stockholders' Equity (SHE)

The residual interest in the assets of a company after deducting liabilities; represents the owners' claims on the business.

SHE consists of 2 components:



Retained Earnings

Retained Earnings (Earned Capital, Equity)

The cumulative amount of net income retained in the business after dividends are paid.

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Retained Earnings Equation

End. RE = Beg. RE + Net Income - Dividends

Retained Earnings — How the Balance Moves

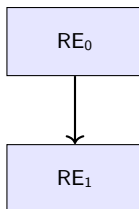
0: business opened 1: Year 1 2: Year 2

 RE_0

- **Retained Earnings > 0**: the company has earned more, over its whole life, than it has paid out as dividends. The difference has been kept in the business.
- **Retained Earnings < 0**: the company's cumulative losses and dividends exceed its cumulative net income. This is called an **accumulated deficit**.

Retained Earnings — How the Balance Moves

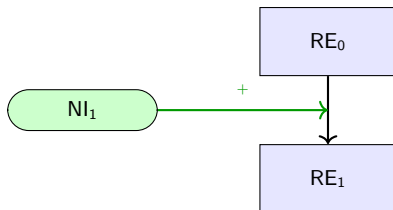
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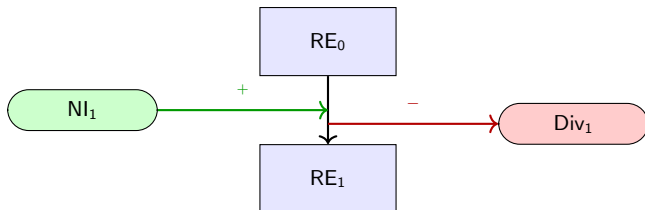
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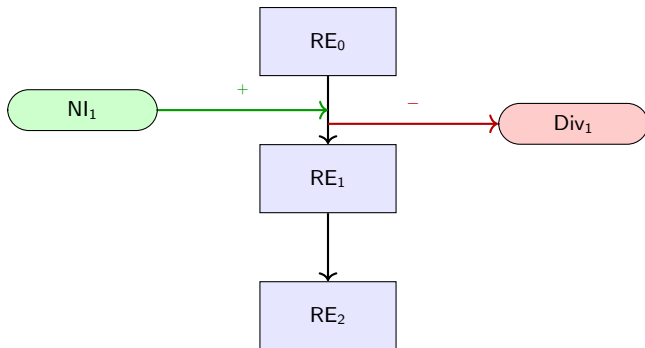
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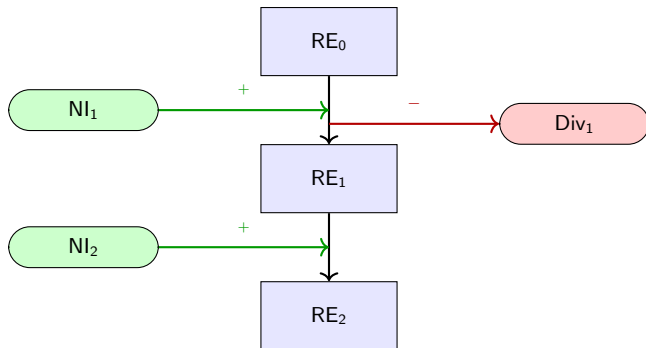
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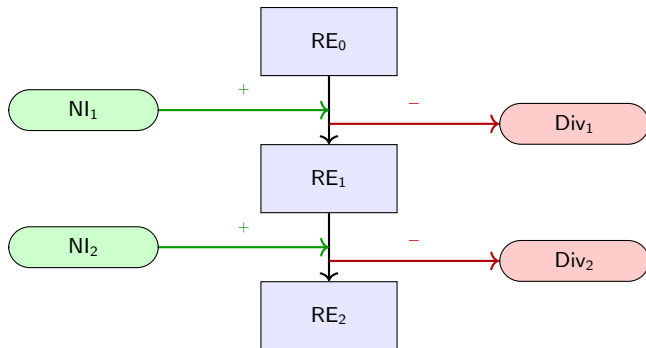
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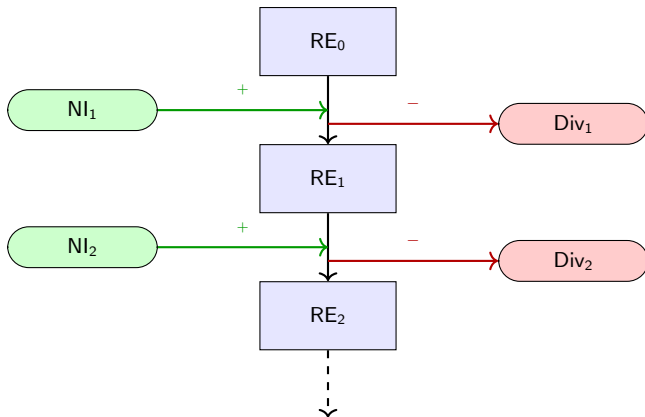
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Contributed Capital (Paid-in Capital, Equity)

The total amount of cash that investors or owners have directly invested into a company in exchange for an ownership stake.

EX 1. How much shareholders' equity do you have after the following transactions?

- You opened a lemonade stand after investing \$50K in cash.
- You bought \$20K of equipment - paid in cash.
- Your employees worked for your business and you owe them \$10K.
- Your revenues are \$30K and all collected in cash.

Hint:

- \$20K equipment is not expensed immediately. It's a long-term asset.
- It will be recognized as an expense over time (we will learn this later).
- \$10K wages are expensed as it incurred though cash will be paid later.

Contributed Capital: _____

Retained Earnings: _____

Shareholders' Equity: _____

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Contributed Capital: \$50K

Retained Earnings: \$20K

Shareholders' Equity: \$70K

EX 2. How much shareholders' equity do you have after the following transactions?

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Contributed Capital: \$50K

Retained Earnings: \$20K

Shareholders' Equity: \$70K

Shareholders' Equity

Calculate Contributed Capital (CC), Retained Earnings (RE), and Shareholders' Equity (SHE) at the end of each year.

EX. Year 1 transactions:

- Initial investment from shareholders: \$10K.
- Borrowed \$20K from a bank.
- Net Income in year 1: \$1K.

At the end of year 1:

CC	_____
RE	_____
SHE	_____

EX. Year 2 transactions:

- Net Income in year 2: \$3K.
- Dividends in year 2: \$2K.

At the end of year 2:

CC	_____
RE	_____
SHE	_____

If the business goes well, the retained earnings will increase (good for shareholders).

Shareholders' Equity

Calculate Contributed Capital (CC), Retained Earnings (RE), and Shareholders' Equity (SHE) at the end of each year.

EX. Year 1 transactions:

- Initial investment from shareholders: \$10K.
- Borrowed \$20K from a bank.
- Net Income in year 1: \$1K.

At the end of year 1:

CC	<u>\$10K</u>
RE	<u> </u>
SHE	<u> </u>

EX. Year 2 transactions:

- Net Income in year 2: \$3K.
- Dividends in year 2: \$2K.

At the end of year 2:

CC	<u> </u>
RE	<u> </u>
SHE	<u> </u>

If the business goes well, the retained earnings will increase (good for shareholders).

Shareholders' Equity

Calculate Contributed Capital (CC), Retained Earnings (RE), and Shareholders' Equity (SHE) at the end of each year.

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- Initial investment from shareholders: \$10K.
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CC	<u>\$10K</u>
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SHE	<u> </u>

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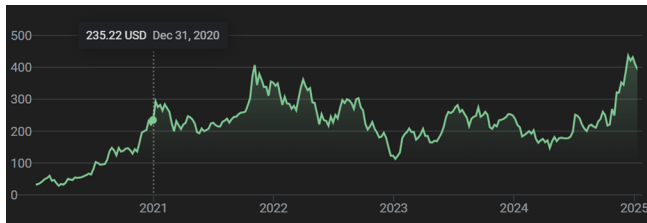
CC	<u>\$10K</u>
RE	<u>\$2K</u>
SHE	<u>\$12K</u>

If the business goes well, the retained earnings will increase (good for shareholders).

- Stakeholders other than shareholders usually receive what they were promised through transactions:
 - ▶ Suppliers: the amount promised for goods and services.
 - ▶ Employees: the amount promised for their work.
 - ▶ Banks: the amount promised for loans.

Shareholders' Equity

- **Stakeholders other than shareholders** usually receive what they were promised through transactions:
 - ▶ Suppliers: the amount promised for goods and services.
 - ▶ Employees: the amount promised for their work.
 - ▶ Banks: the amount promised for loans.
- **Shareholders are different**: they are the **owners** of the corporation.
- Shareholders are **residual claimants** and enjoy all ups-and-downs of the corporation (and its stock price).



Now that we have seen each one, here are the formal definitions.

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Basic Accounting Equation

- Assets (A) = Liabilities (L) + Stockholders' Equity (SHE)
(Resources) = (Sources of Resources)

Let's confirm the equation $A = L + SHE$ with examples.²

EX 1.

- You opened a lemonade stand after investing \$50K in cash.
- You bought \$20K of equipment - paid in cash.
- Your employees worked for your business and you owe them \$10K.
- Your revenues are \$30K and all collected in cash.

A: _____
L: _____
SHE: _____

EX 2.

- You opened a lemonade stand after investing \$50K in cash.
- You bought \$20K of equipment - on credit.
- Your employees worked for your business and you owe them \$10K.
- Your revenues are \$30K and all collected in cash.

A: _____
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Let's confirm the equation $A = L + SHE$ with examples.²

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A: \$80K
L: _____
SHE: _____

EX 2.

- You opened a lemonade stand after investing \$50K in cash.
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A:	<u>\$80K</u>
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A:	<u>\$100K</u>
L:	<u> </u>
SHE:	<u> </u>

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1 Corporations as a Common Form of Business Organization

2 Accounting for Business Decisions

3 Basic Accounting Equation: $A = L + SHE$

- Assets
- Liabilities
- Shareholders' Equity
- $A = L + SHE$

4 Financial Statements

- Income Statement
- Statement of Retained Earnings
- Balance Sheet
- Statement of Cash Flows
- Relationship between Financial Statements

5 Types of Business Activities

6 Closing Illustration

7 List of A & L accounts

- Used to make business decisions.
- Used to communicate with stakeholders.
- Four main financial statements:
 - 1 Income Statement
 - 2 Statement of Retained Earnings³
 - 3 Balance Sheet
 - 4 Statement of Cash Flows

³ S of Retained Earnings is not a standalone financial statement. It's part of S of Shareholders' Equity. As an introductory course, we will not cover S of Shareholders' Equity but will cover S of Retained Earnings. 

- ④ Public companies are required to report financial statements to the Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC).

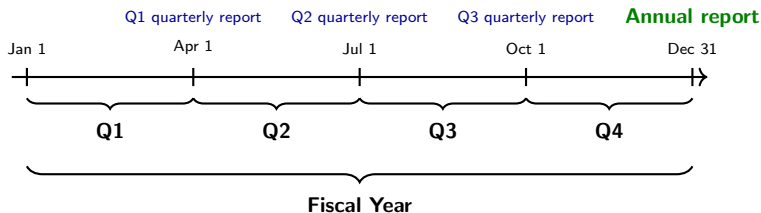
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Financial Statements

- 1 Public companies are required to report financial statements to the Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC).
- 2 Each company has its own fiscal-year end and fiscal-year period.
- 3 For example, Crocs' fiscal-year end is December 31st.
- 4 The company reports financial statements for the fiscal year ended December 31st.
- 5 In addition to the annual reports, quarterly reports are also required.



1. Income Statement

Income Statement

A financial statement that reports a company's revenues, expenses, and net income over a period of time.

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A financial statement that reports a company's revenues, expenses, and net income over a period of time.

Lemonade Stand, Inc.
Income Statement
For the Year Ended December 31, 2025

Revenues	\$500
Salaries Expense	\$200
Supplies Expense	\$100
<u>Net Income</u>	<u>\$200</u>

2. Statement of Retained Earnings

Statement of Retained Earnings

A financial statement that shows changes in retained earnings over a period, including net income and dividends.

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Statement of Retained Earnings

A financial statement that shows changes in retained earnings over a period, including net income and dividends.

Lemonade Stand, Inc.
Statement of Retained Earnings
For the Year Ended December 31, 2025

Beg. Retained Earnings	\$0
+) <u>Net Income</u>	<u>\$200</u>
-) Dividends	(\$100)
<u>End. Retained Earnings</u>	<u>\$100</u>

3. Balance Sheet

Balance Sheet

A financial statement that shows a company's assets, liabilities, and equity at a specific point in time.

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Balance Sheet

A financial statement that shows a company's assets, liabilities, and equity at a specific point in time.

Lemonade Stand, Inc. Balance Sheet As of December 31, 2025	
Assets	
Cash	\$300
Equipment	\$300
Total Assets	\$600
Liabilities	
Accounts Payable	\$100
Salaries Payable	\$0
Shareholders' Equity	
Contributed Capital	\$400
Retained Earnings	\$100
Total Liabilities & Equity	\$600

4. Statement of Cash Flows [Appendix]

Statement of Cash Flows

A financial statement that summarizes the cash inflows and outflows from operating, investing, and financing activities over a period.

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A financial statement that summarizes the cash inflows and outflows from operating, investing, and financing activities over a period.

Lemonade Stand, Inc.
Statement of Cash Flows
For the Year Ended December 31, 2025

Operating Cash	\$300
Investing Cash	(\$300)
Financing Cash	\$300
Net Cash Change	\$300
Beg. Cash	\$0
End. Cash	\$300

- The ending balance of cash should be the same as the ending balance of cash in the balance sheet.
- The S of Cash Flows is included here for reference, but we do **not** cover this statement in this course.

Income Statement Equation

$\text{Net Income} = \text{Revenues} - \text{Expenses}$

Income Statement Equation

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Retained Earnings Equation

$$\text{End. RE} = \text{Beg. RE} + \text{Net Income} - \text{Dividends}$$

Income Statement Equation

$\text{Net Income} = \text{Revenues} - \text{Expenses}$

Retained Earnings Equation

$\text{End. RE} = \text{Beg. RE} + \text{Net Income} - \text{Dividends}$

Balance Sheet Equation

$\text{Assets} = \text{Liabilities} + \text{Shareholders' Equity}$

Relationship between Financial Statements

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Relationship between Financial Statements

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End. Retained Earnings	\$100

Lemonade Stand, Inc.
Balance Sheet
As of December 31, 2025

Assets

Cash	\$300
Equipment	\$300

Total Assets **\$600**

Liabilities

Accounts Payable	\$100
Salaries Payable	\$0

Shareholders' Equity

Contributed Capital	\$400
Retained Earnings	\$100

Total Liabilities & Equity **\$600**

Relationship between Financial Statements

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Lemonade Stand, Inc.
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Assets

Cash	\$300
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Total Assets **\$600**

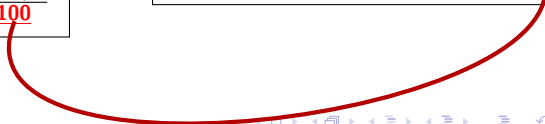
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Relationship between Financial Statements

Cash Balance from
Cash Flows Statement

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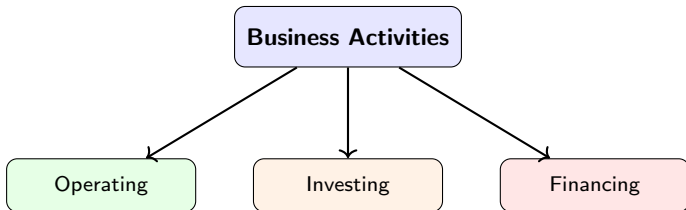
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5 Types of Business Activities

6 Closing Illustration

7 List of A & L accounts

Three Types of Business Activities



Three Types of Business Activities

Operating Activities:

- Those related to the day-to-day operations of the business.
 - ▶ Generating revenues;
 - ▶ Using resources to generate revenues (i.e., Expenses).
 - ▶ (*) Paying interests.⁴

⁴(*) Repaying the principal is a financing activity, while paying interest is usually classified as an operating activity under U.S. GAAP, because interest is a cost of doing business. But it could be classified as a financing activity. Firms have discretion for this.

Three Types of Business Activities

Operating Activities:

- Those related to the day-to-day operations of the business.
 - ▶ Generating revenues;
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Financing Activities:

- Those related to obtaining or repaying funds used to finance the business.
 - ▶ Raising capital from shareholders (issuing stock)
 - ▶ Borrowing from creditors (taking loans)
 - ▶ Paying dividends to shareholders
 - ▶ Repaying loans
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 - ▶ Raising capital from shareholders (**issuing stock**)
 - ▶ Borrowing from creditors (taking **loans**)
 - ▶ Paying dividends to shareholders
 - ▶ Repaying loans
 - ▶ (*) Paying interests.

Investing Activities:

- Those related to acquiring or disposing of **long-term assets**.
 - ▶ Purchasing equipment, land, or buildings
 - ▶ Selling long-term assets

⁴(*)Repaying the principal is a financing activity, while **paying interest** is usually classified as an **operating activity** under U.S. GAAP. because interest is a cost of doing business. But it could be classified as a **financing activity**. Firms have discretion for this.

Closing Illustration

Required:

- Classify each transaction into one of the three types of business activities.
- Enter the amount of the transaction in the appropriate column.

Description	Type	A	L	R	E	CC
You invested \$10K into your business.	F	+10K				+10K
Your business used \$5K to buy kitchen appliances.						
Your business borrowed \$20K from PNC bank.						
Your business recorded \$3K revenues (and collected \$3K cash).						
Your business paid \$1K interest to PNC bank.						
Your business paid \$10K wages to employees.						
You convinced your friends to invest \$20K into your business.						

¹Asset composition changes: cash decreases, equipment increases by \$5K; total assets unchanged.

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Your business used \$5K to buy kitchen appliances.	I	<u>+5K</u> <u>-5K</u> ¹				
Your business borrowed \$20K from PNC bank.	F	<u>+20K</u>	<u>+20K</u>			
Your business recorded \$3K revenues (and collected \$3K cash).	Q	<u>+3K</u>		<u>+3K</u>		
Your business paid \$1K interest to PNC bank.						
Your business paid \$10K wages to employees.						
You convinced your friends to invest \$20K into your business.						

¹Asset composition changes: cash decreases, equipment increases by \$5K; total assets unchanged.▶

Closing Illustration

Required:

- Classify each transaction into one of the three types of business activities.
- Enter the amount of the transaction in the appropriate column.

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Recall:

- $A = L + SHE$.
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- $RE_t = RE_{t-1} + NI_t - Div_t$. (where t is the current year)
- $NI_t = R_t - E_t$.

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Asset Accounts

Asset Account	Definition
Cash	Money available for immediate use, including currency, coins, and balances in checking accounts.
Accounts Receivable	Amounts owed to the business by customers for goods or services delivered but not yet paid for.
Inventory	Goods held for sale in the ordinary course of business.
Prepaid Expenses	Payments made in advance for goods or services to be received in the future (e.g., prepaid rent, prepaid insurance).
Equipment	Tangible long-term assets used in operations, such as machinery, computers, and vehicles.
Supplies	Items used in the course of business operations that are not intended for sale (e.g., office supplies).
Land	The cost of land owned by the business, not subject to depreciation.
Buildings	Structures owned and used in business operations.

Liability Accounts

Liability Account	Definition
Accounts Payable	Amounts owed to suppliers for goods or services received but not yet paid for.
Notes Payable	Amounts owed to banks for loans taken.
Interest Payable	Amounts owed to banks for interest not yet paid.
Salaries Payable	Amounts owed to employees for wages not yet paid.
Taxes Payable	Amounts owed to government for taxes not yet paid.
Deferred Revenue	Revenue received in advance for goods or services to be provided in the future (e.g., prepaid rent, prepaid insurance).